SAVEETHA
INSTITUTE OF MEDICAL AND TECHNICAL SCIENCES
(Declared as Deemed to be University under Section 3 of UGC Act 1956)

Programme: B.E / B.Tech
Course Code: MLA02
Course Name: FUNDAMENTALS OF MACHINE LEARNING
Duration: 1:30 Hr
Date : 31-10-2026

Max Marks: 50 Marks

ASSIGNMENT – I

UNIT I – INTRODUCTION AND MATHEMATICAL FOUNDATIONS

Topics: *Design of a learning system, types of machine learning, probability theory and distributions, Bayes decision theory, information theory*

Course Outcome

On successful completion of this assignment, students will be able to:

CO	Course Outcome Statement
CO1	Analyse machine learning fundamentals and mathematical foundations, including probability theory, Bayes decision theory, and information theory.

Answer all the Tasks

Task 1. A retail bank plans five machine-learning systems. For each system, analyse the problem and state (i) the learning paradigm (supervised / unsupervised / semi-supervised / reinforcement), (ii) the learning task (classification, regression, clustering, control, etc.) and (iii) the experience E and performance measure P in Mitchell's (T, P, E) formulation:

(a) Predict whether a loan applicant will default, using ten years of labelled repayment records.

(b) Discover behavioural customer segments among 2 million customers for which no labels exist.

(c) Estimate the next-month credit-card spend (in ₹) of each customer.

(d) Learn an ATM cash-refill policy that maximises cash availability minus transport cost through repeated trial and feedback.

(e) Only 2% of 500,000 transaction records are labelled fraud/genuine; the rest are unlabelled. Build a fraud detector that exploits both kinds of data.

Finally, justify which of the five systems is most harmed by label noise. **(5) (CO1) (BL4)**

Task 2. A screening test for a disease with prevalence 2% has sensitivity 95% and specificity 90%. Calculate the probability that a person who tests positive actually has the disease, and analyse why the answer is much lower than the sensitivity. **(2) (CO1) (BL4)**

Task 3. The joint probability mass function of a discrete random vector (X, Y) is given below.

X \ Y	Y = 0	Y = 1
X = 0	0.10	0.20
X = 1	0.15	0.25

X \ Y	Y = 0	Y = 1
X = 2	0.20	0.10

Analyse the distribution by (a) finding the marginals of X and Y, (b) computing E[X], Var(X) and E[Y], (c) computing $P(X = 2 \mid Y = 1)$, (d) computing Cov(X, Y) and the correlation coefficient, and (e) deciding whether X and Y are independent, with a justification.

Task 4. A temperature sensor output is modelled as $X \sim N(\mu = 50, \sigma^2 = 16)$. **(6) (CO1) (BL4)**

(a) Calculate $P(X > 58)$ and $P(46 < X < 54)$.

(b) A second sensor gives the readings 12, 15, 11, 14, 13. Derive the maximum-likelihood estimates of its mean and variance and compare the ML variance with the unbiased estimate, stating which is biased and why. (Use $\Phi(1) = 0.8413$, $\Phi(2) = 0.9772$.)

Task 5. A source emits four symbols with probabilities (1/2, 1/4, 1/8, 1/8). Calculate its entropy, compare it with the entropy of a uniform source over four symbols, and analyse the redundancy. Also compute the average length of the code {0, 10, 110, 111} and comment on its optimality. **(4) (CO1) (BL4)**

Task 6. A model predicts class probabilities Q = (1/3, 1/3, 1/3) while the true distribution is P = (0.5, 0.25, 0.25). Compute KL(P||Q) and KL(Q||P) in bits, and analyse what the asymmetry implies when KL divergence is used as a training loss. **(3) (CO1) (BL4)**

Task 7. Two binary variables A and B have the joint distribution $P(0,0) = 0.4$, $P(0,1) = 0.1$, $P(1,0) = 0.1$, $P(1,1) = 0.4$. Calculate H(A), H(B), the joint entropy H(A,B), the conditional entropy H(A|B) and the mutual information I(A;B). Analyse what the value of I(A;B) says about using B as a feature to predict A. **(3) (CO1) (BL4)**

Task 8. A one-dimensional feature x follows $p(x|\omega_1) = N(2, 4)$ for class ω_1 and $p(x|\omega_2) = N(6, 4)$ for class ω_2, with priors $P(\omega_1) = 0.6$ and $P(\omega_2) = 0.4$ and zero–one loss. Derive the Bayes decision threshold x^*, classify x = 4.5, and calculate the overall probability of error. Analyse how the threshold moves as the prior of ω_1 increases. **(4) (CO1) (BL4)**

Task 9. For an observation x, the posteriors are $P(\omega_1|x) = 0.3$ (disease) and $P(\omega_2|x) = 0.7$ (healthy). Action α_1 = 'declare disease', α_2 = 'declare healthy'. The loss matrix is $\lambda(\alpha_1|\omega_1) = 0$, $\lambda(\alpha_1|\omega_2) = 8$ (unnecessary treatment), $\lambda(\alpha_2|\omega_1) = 50$ (missed disease), $\lambda(\alpha_2|\omega_2) = 0$. Evaluate the conditional risks, decide the minimum-risk action, compare it with the MAP decision and determine the posterior $P(\omega_1|x)$ above which α_1 is optimal. **(4) (CO1) (BL4)**

Task 10. Polynomial regression models of increasing degree were fitted to the same dataset, giving the mean-squared errors below. **(3) (CO1) (BL5)**

Degree	1	2	3	5	9
Training MSE	9.0	4.1	2.2	0.9	0.1

Degree	1	2	3	5	9
Validation MSE	9.5	4.6	2.9	3.6	11.8

Calculate the generalisation gap for each degree, diagnose under-fitting/over-fitting using the bias–variance trade-off, select the best model with justification, and recommend two techniques to improve the degree-9 model.

(4) (CO1) (BL5)

Task 11. A coin is tossed 10 times and shows 7 heads. The bias θ = P(head) is given a Beta(2, 2) prior. Calculate the ML estimate, the MAP estimate and the posterior mean of θ. Then evaluate how the three estimates change if the data were 70 heads in 100 tosses, and explain the role of the prior.

(4) (CO1) (BL5)

Task 12. A hospital wants an early-warning system that raises an alert when an ICU patient is likely to develop sepsis within the next 6 hours. Historical electronic health records (vital signs, lab values, outcomes) are available.

(a) Design the learning system: state the task T, performance measure P and experience E, the target function, a suitable input representation, a learning algorithm and the validation strategy. [3]

(b) On a validation cohort of 1,000 patients, 5% develop sepsis. The trained model has sensitivity 0.90 and specificity 0.80. Compute TP, FN, FP and TN. [1]

(c) Compute the positive predictive value (PPV) and negative predictive value (NPV). [1]

(d) A missed sepsis case costs ₹100 (unit cost) and a false alarm costs ₹5. Compare the total cost of (i) using the model, (ii) alerting every patient and (iii) never alerting. [2]

(e) Recommend a deployment policy and justify how the alert threshold should be set using Bayes decision theory. [1]

(8) (CO1) (BL6)

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ANSWER SCRIPT EVALUATION SHEET

ASSIGNMENT - I

Programme	B.E / B.Tech	**Course Code**	**MLA02**
Course Name	**Fundamentals of Machine learning.**	**Date**	
Duration	1 Hr 30 Min	**Max Marks**	50

Register No.: 192461020

TASK 1	Max Marks	Marks Awarded
Task 1	5	4
Task 2	2	2
Task 3	6	6
Task 4	4	4
Task 5	3	3
Task 6	3	3
Task 7	4	4
Task 8	4	32
Task 9	3	12
Task 10	4	2
Task 11	4	4
Task 12	8	8
TOTAL	**50**	45

Total in words: forty five.

45/50

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AT-1

1. Learning Paradigms & Mitchell's T-P-E.

a) loan default Prediction.
Paradigm : Supervised learning
Task : classification
T : Predict loan default
P : Accuracy
E : 10 yrs of labelled repayment records.

b) customer segmentation.
Paradigm : Unsupervised learning
Task : clustering.
T : Group similar customer
P : silhouette score
E : 2 million unlabelled customer records.

c) credit-card spend prediction.
Paradigm : supervised learning
Task : Control & optimization
T : maximize cash availability & minimize transport cost.
P : Average cumulative reward
E : Repeated trials & feedback.

d) ATM cash-refill policy
paradigm : Reinforcement learning
Task : classification
T : Detect fraudulent transactions
P : precision, recall & F1-score
E : 2% labelled & 98% unlabelled records.

2. Baye's theorem.
Given :
Prevalance : 0.02
Sensitivity : 0.95

specificity = 0.90

False +ve rate = 0.10

$$P(D|+) = \frac{0.02(0.98)}{0.02(0.98) + 0.98(0.10)}$$

$$= \frac{0.019}{0.117}$$

$$= 16.24\%$$

3) Joint probability distribution.

a) Marginal probabilities.

For X:

$P(X=0) = 0.10 + 0.20 = 0.30$

$P(X=1) = 0.15 + 0.25 = 0.40$

$P(X=2) = 0.20 + 0.10 = 0.30$

for Y:

$P(Y=0) = 0.45$, $P(Y=1) = 0.55$

b) expected values & variance.

$E(X) = 0(0.3) + 1(0.4) + 2(0.3) = 1$

$E(X^2) = 0 + 0.4 + 1.2 = 1.6$

$Var(X) = 1.6 - 1^2 = 0.6$

$E(Y) = 0(0.45) + 1(0.55) = 0.55$

c) conditional probability.

$$P(X=2|Y=1) = \frac{0.10}{0.55} = 0.1818$$

d) Covariance & correlation

$E(XY) = 0 + 0.25 + 0.20 = 0.45$

$Cov(X,Y) = 0.45 - 1(0.55)$

$= -0.10$

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$$P = \frac{-0.10}{\sqrt{0.6(0.2475)}}$$

$$= -0.2593$$

c) Independence

X & Y are not independent, because:

$P(X=0, Y=0) = 0.10$

$P(X=0)\ P(Y=0) = 0.30(0.45) = 0.135$

Both are unequal.

4. Normal distribution

Given:

$\mu = 50, \quad \sigma^2 = 16, \quad \sigma = 4$

a) Find Probabilities.

i, $P(X > 58)$

$$z = \frac{58-50}{4} = 2$$

$P(X > 58) = 1 - 0.9772$

$= 0.0228$

ii, $P(46 < X < 54)$

$$z_1 = \frac{46-50}{4} = -1$$

$$z_2 = \frac{54-50}{4} = 1$$

$= 0.8413 - 0.1587$

$= 0.6826$

b) Max likelihood estimates

Readings : 12, 15, 11, 14, 13.

$$\bar{X} = \frac{12+15+11+14+13}{5} = 13$$

$$\hat{\mu}_{ML} = 13$$

$$\hat{\sigma}^2_{ML} = \frac{10}{5} = 2$$

Unbiased variance :

$$S^2 = \frac{10}{5-1} = 2.5$$

5. Entropy & coding.

Given probabilities:

$$P = \left(\frac{1}{2}, \frac{1}{4}, \frac{1}{8}, \frac{1}{8}\right)$$

Entropy :

$$H = -\sum p_i \log_2 p_i$$

$$= 0.5 + 0.5 + 0.375 + 0.375$$

$$H = 1.75 \text{ bits.}$$

Uniform entropy :

$$H = \log_2 4 = 2 \text{ bits}$$

Redundancy :

$$R = 2 - 1.75 = 0.25 \text{ bits}$$

Average code length :

$$L = 0.5(1) + 0.25(2) + 0.125(3) + 0.125(3)$$

$$L = 1.75 \text{ bits}$$

6. KL Divergence

Given :

$$P = (0.5, 0.25, 0.25)$$

$Q = (1/3, 1/3, 1/3)$

$KL(P||Q) = \sum p_i \log_2 \frac{p_i}{q_i}$

$= 0.08496$ bits.

Similarly,

$KL(Q||P) = 0.08170$ bits.

$KL(P||Q) \neq KL(Q||P)$

7. Information theory.

Given:

$P(0,0) = 0.4$, $P(0,1) = 0.1$

$P(1,0) = 0.1$, $P(1,1) = 0.4$

Marginals:

$P(A=0) = P(A=1) = 0.5$

$P(B=0) = P(B=1) = 0.5$

$H(A) = H(B) = 1$ bit

Joint entropy:

$H(A,B) = -2(0.4 \log_2 0.4) - 2(0.1 \log_2 0.1)$

$= 1.7219$ bits.

Conditional entropy:

$H(A|B) = 1.7219 - 1$

$= 0.7219$ bits

Mutual information:

$I(A;B) = H(A) - H(A|B)$

$= 0.2781$ bits.

8. Bayesian classification.

Given:

$P(\omega_1) = 0.6$, $P(\omega_2) = 0.4$

$\omega_1 = N(2,4)$, $\omega_2 = N(6,4)$

Bayes decision threshold:

$$x^* = 4 + \ln\left(\frac{0.6}{0.4}\right)$$

$$x^* = 4.4055$$

for $x = 4.5$

$4.5 > 4.4055$

Overall probability of error:

$$P_e = 0.6\, P(x > 4.4055 | \omega_1) + 0.4\, P(x < 4.4055 | \omega_2)$$

$$= 0.6\,(0.4146) + 0.4\,(0.2127)$$

$$P_e \approx 0.1538$$

9. Minimum Risk decision.

Given:

$P(\omega_1|x) = 0.3$, $P(\omega_2|x) = 0.7$

Risk of declaring disease:

$$R(\alpha_1) = 0(0.3) + 8(0.7)$$

$$= 5.6$$

Risk of declaring healthy:

$$R(\alpha_2) = 50(0.3) + 0(0.7)$$

$$= 15$$

10. Polynomial Regression.

Generalization gap = Validation MSE − Training MSE

Degree	Training MSE	Validation MSE	Gap.
1	9.0	9.5	0.5
2	4.1	4.6	0.5
3	2.2	2.9	0.7
4	0.9	3.6	2.7
5	0.1	11.8	11.7

Diagnosis :

- Degree 1 : Underfitting (High bias)
- Degree 2 : Better fit
- Degree 3 : Best generation
- Degree 5 : overfitting begins
- Degree 9 : Severe overfitting (High variance)

Best model : Degree 3.

Two improvement techniques :

1. L1/L2 regularization.
2. Cross-validation & early stopping.

10. Bayesian Estimation.

Given :

$\theta \sim$ Beta (2, 2)

10 tosses, 7 heads & 3 tails.

initial data.

i) Maximum likelihood :

$$\hat{\theta}_{ML} = 7/10 = 0.7$$

ii) MAP:

$$\hat{\theta}_{MAP} = \frac{7+1}{10+2} = \frac{8}{12} = 0.6667$$

iii) Posterior Mean :

$$E(\theta) = \frac{7+2}{10+4} = \frac{9}{14} = 0.6429$$

New data : 70 heads in 100 tosses.

Posterior :

$B(72, 32)$

ML :

0.7

MAP : $\frac{71}{102} = 0.6961$

Posterior mean :

$\frac{72}{104} = 0.6923$

12) sepsis prediction system.

a) learning system design.

T : predict sepsis within 6 hrs

P : sensitivity, specificity & accuracy

E : historical patient records

Target function : probability of sepsis.

Representation : patient vital sign, lab values + clinical history.

Algorithm : logistic regression / Random forest

validation : Independent validation dataset

b) Confusion matrix.

total patients = 1000

Sepsis = 5% of 1000 = 50

Healthy = 950

TP = 50 (0.90) = 45

FN = 50 - 45 = 5

TN = 950 (0.80) = 760

FP = 950 - 760 = 190

	Actual sepsis	Actual healthy
Predicted positive	TP = 45	FP = 190
Predicted -ve	FN = 5	TN = 760

c) PPV & NPV

$$PPV = \frac{45}{45+190}$$

PPV = 19.15 %.

$$NPV = \frac{760}{760+5} = \frac{760}{765}$$

NPV = 99.35 %.

d) Total cost comparison.

i) using the model:

cost = (5 x 100) + (190 x 5)

= ₹ 1450

ii) Alerting every patient:

cost = 950 x 5

= ₹ 4750

iii) Never Alerting:

cost = 50 x 100

= ₹ 5000

e) Deployment policy

Deploy the model with continuous monitoring + clinician verification.

using Bayes decision theory:

$$P(\text{Sepsis} \mid x) > \frac{5}{100+5}$$

Threshold = 0.0476 = 4.76%.